

APM ASSIGNMENT

B2B SaaS L&D Platform

Improving Learner Engagement & Course Completion Rates

SLIDE 1

Executive Summary

COMPLETION CRISIS

Only 35% of learners complete self-paced courses — the majority abandon despite enrolling with genuine intent.

APPLICATION GAP

Even completers rarely apply what they learn on the job. L&D leaders cannot measure or prove behavior change to the business.

Key Insight — Why Self-Paced Learning Fails

Self-paced learning removes every external accountability mechanism that makes instructor-led learning work: no schedule, no milestones, no peer pressure, no manager visibility, and no bridge between course content and on-the-job behavior. Learners start with good intentions and a blank calendar. The product does nothing to convert that intent into a plan. The result is drift — not laziness.

Recommended Solution

Guided Learning Commitments — a structured enrollment experience that gives every self-paced learner a deadline, a milestone plan, application checkpoints, and passive manager visibility. No lectures. No cohort coordination. Full flexibility preserved.

Expected Impact & Why This Matters

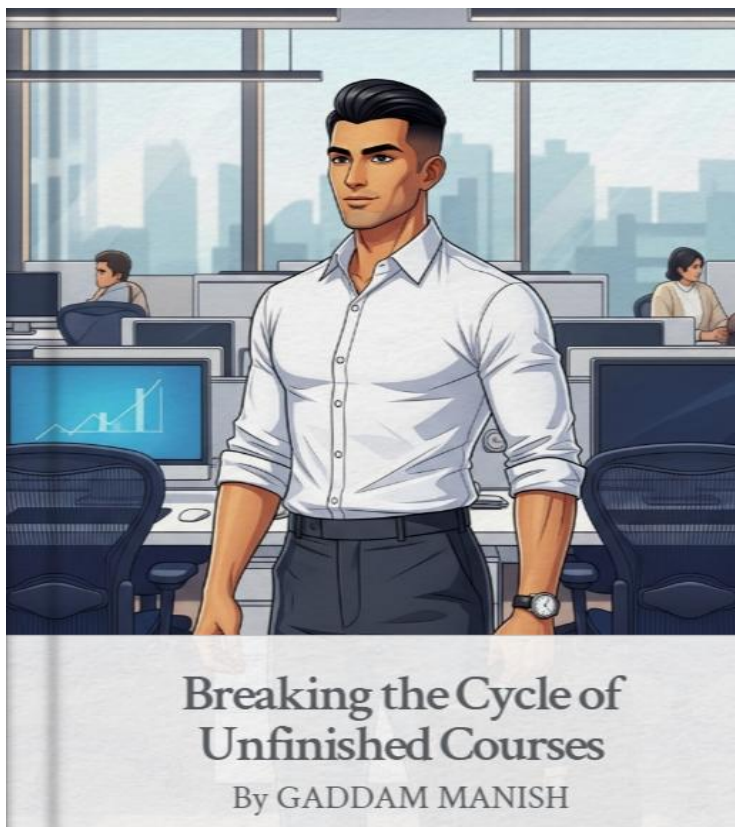
For Learners	For L&D Leaders	For Enterprises
A plan that keeps them on track without relying on daily self-discipline. Immediate relevance from application challenges.	First-ever learning application metric. Completion rates that justify platform spend and demonstrate ROI to the CFO.	Measurable behavior change, not just course certificates. Training investment that translates to improved team performance.

SLIDE 2

User Personas & Pain Points

Persona	Learner	L&D Leader	Manager
Who	Employees in self-paced courses	Learning admins & training owners	Team leaders & people managers
Goals	Complete courses, build skills, balance work	Improve completion, skill adoption, business impact	Grow team capability, improve performance
JTBD	Clear path to finish training without disrupting work	Ensure course completion and learning impact	Track progress and support development efficiently
Pain Points	• No urgency • Low motivation • Learning deprioritized • Abstract progress • Unsure application	• Low completion • Poor engagement visibility • Hard to prove impact • Limited application insights	• Limited progress visibility • Can't spot at-risk learners • Little coaching time • Unclear learning transfer

Persona Story Link: <https://gemini.google.com/share/88bc7018a2c1>



SLIDE 3

User Insights, Root Causes & User Journey

Key User Insights

Observation	Insight
Learners begin courses with enthusiasm	Motivation drops without structure
Work priorities compete with learning	Learning often gets deprioritized
Percentage progress lacks meaning	Milestones create urgency and clarity
Course completion does not guarantee behavior change	Learning must be applied in context
Reflection improves retention	Active recall reinforces learning
Visibility increases accountability	Learners are more likely to finish when progress is visible

Root Causes

Low Course Completion - Lack of structure - Lack of accountability - Low motivation - Competing work priorities	Poor Learning Application - Passive content consumption - No reinforcement - No reflection - No real-world application
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User Journey

Stage	User Goal	Pain Point	Opportunity
Enroll	Start learning	No commitment	Create completion commitment
Set Commitment	Define target	No plan	Generate personalized timeline
Receive Milestones	Understand journey	Content feels overwhelming	Create structured milestones
Learn	Complete modules	Motivation decreases	Provide milestone visibility
Apply Learning	Use skills	No practical application	Introduce application challenges
Reflect	Reinforce learning	Poor retention	Add reflection logs
Complete Course	Finish successfully	High drop-off	Increase accountability

SLIDE 4

Prioritization Matrix

Evaluated on user impact, business impact, engineering effort, and directness of fit to the root cause.

Option	Impact	Effort	Pros	Cons
Guided Learning Commitments	High	Medium	Addresses root cause directly; preserves flexibility; minimal manager lift; introduces application metric	Requires enrollment flow change; new manager view
Reminders & nudges	Low-Med	Low	Quick to ship; familiar pattern; low engineering risk	Solves "I forgot" — not "I have no deadline" or "I see no value". Notification fatigue within weeks.
Gamification (badges/points)	Low-Med	Medium	Engaging short-term; familiar UX pattern	Extrinsic motivation; novelty fades in 4–6 weeks; does not address accountability or application
AI coach	High	Very High	Personalized; adaptive; strong long-term potential	Requires ML infrastructure; high build cost; months to first signal; v1 risk is high
Learning cohorts	High	Very High	Social accountability; mimics ILT mechanisms most closely	Destroys self-paced flexibility; scheduling complexity; coordination overhead; low adoption risk
Peer accountability pairs	Medium	Medium	Social layer without full cohort complexity	Pairing logic is complex; if one drops out, both are affected; requires critical mass
Manager nudges	Medium	Low-Med	Creates external pressure; low engineering lift	Adds manager overhead, manager bandwidth.

✓ **Guided Learning Commitments is selected — it addresses the root cause directly, introduces a new application metric, preserves self-paced flexibility, and requires moderate engineering effort.**

SLIDE 5

Recommended Solution

Feature Name: Guided Learning Commitments

The feature brings instructor-led learning benefits while preserving flexibility. It gives every self-paced learner a structured enrollment experience with a deadline, milestone plan, application checkpoints, and passive manager visibility.

Core Components

- 1 Commitment Creation**
 Learner sets a completion timeline at enrollment (2/4/6 weeks or custom date) and states their goal in one sentence. Converts intent into a personal contract before the first lesson plays.
- 2 Milestone Planning**
 System auto-generates 3–4 named milestones with specific target dates based on course length and chosen timeline. Replaces abstract scheduling with a concrete plan.
- 3 Milestone-Based Progress Tracking**
 "Milestone 2 of 4 — due in 3 days" replaces "37% complete." Creates urgency and a meaningful sense of being ahead, on track, or behind.
- 4 Application Challenges**
 After key module blocks, a lightweight prompt asks the learner to apply one concept at work and briefly describe what happened. 2–3 minutes. No manager review required.
- 5 Reflection Logs**
 Short free-text entries tied to each application challenge. Builds durable memory through active recall and generates the platform's first behavioral evidence of learning application.
- 6 Manager Visibility Dashboard**
 Passive, read-only team view showing On Track / At Risk / Overdue per learner. Zero approvals, zero reviews. Visibility itself creates implicit accountability.

Feature → Problem → Business Value

Feature	User Problem Solved	Business Value
Commitment Creation	Learner has no deadline or plan at enrollment	Converts enrollment to active intent; reduces early abandonment
Milestone Planning	No structure to organize learning time	Increases weekly active learners; improves time-to-complete
Milestone Progress Tracking	% progress creates no urgency	Improves course resume rate; reduces stall drop-off
Application Challenges	Learning feels disconnected from daily work	Introduces learning application rate — a new ROI metric for L&D
Reflection Logs	No mechanism to reinforce retention	Generates behavioral evidence L&D can report to business stakeholders
Manager Dashboard	No visibility until it's too late	Passive accountability layer

SLIDE 6 - Wireframes

WF-1: Commitment Setup Screen

Commitment Setup

Sales Negotiation Masterclass
6 hours · 4 modules

When will you complete this?

○ 2 weeks

● 4 weeks

○ 6 weeks

○ Custom date

Why are you taking this course?

Improve customer negot...

Your plan preview:
Milestone 1 → Jul 10
Milestone 2 → Jul 18
Complete → Jul 30

Create my plan →

Design Notes

Goal: Capture commitment + intent at peak motivation

Key Elements: Timeline selector, goal input, plan preview

Primary Action: Create my plan

WF-2: Learning Dashboard

Learning Dashboard

My Learning Plan
Target: July 30 · On Track ✓

● Milestone 1 Completed ✓

▶ Milestone 2 Due Jul 18 ←now
[■■■■■] 3 of 5 done

○ Milestone 3 Jul 25

○ Complete Jul 30

Next up: Module 4 - Anchoring

Continue learning →

Design Notes

Goal: Create urgency through milestone framing — not %

Key Elements: Milestone list, due dates, status, progress bar

Primary Action: Continue learning

WF-3: Application Challenge Screen

Application Challenge

Application Challenge
Module 2: Anchoring Technique

Use an anchoring technique in your next customer conversation.

What happened?

(2-3 sentences) | |

Skip | Submit → | |

Design Notes

Goal: Bridge learning to on-the-job behavior

Key Elements: Application prompt, free-text reflection, skip option

Primary Action: Submit reflection

WF-4: Manager Overview Dashboard

Manager Overview

Team Learning Overview
12 enrolled · This quarter

On Track 7	At Risk 3	Overdue 2
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Name	Course	Status
Priya	Negot.	✓ On Track
Rahul	Leader.	⚠ At Risk
Sana	Excel	✗ Overdue
+ 9 more		

Updated: today (read-only)

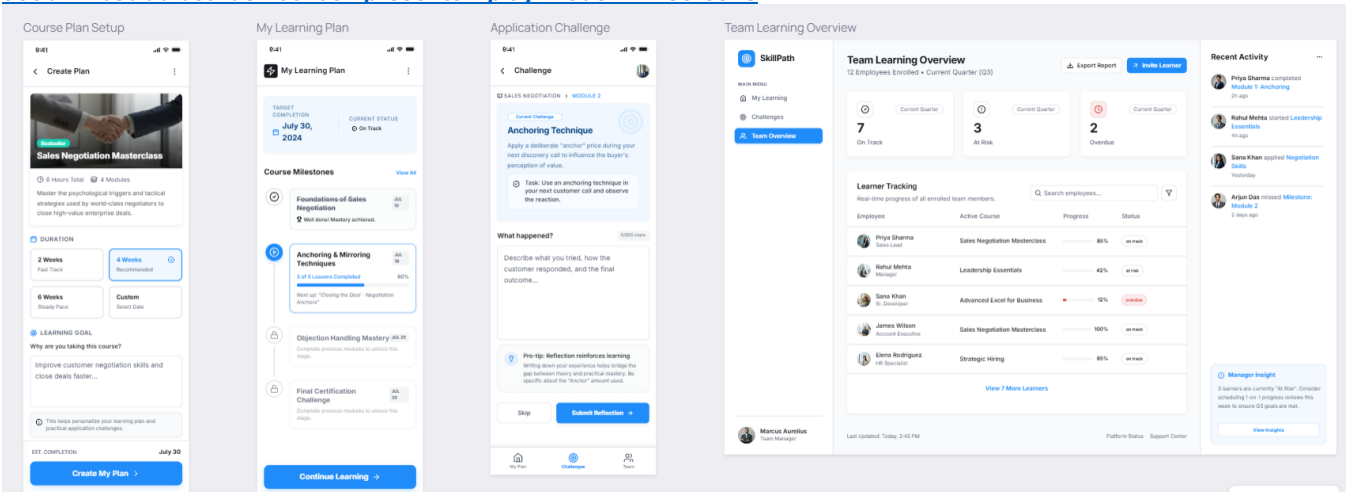
Design Notes

Goal: Passive, zero-effort visibility for managers

Key Elements: Summary counts, per-learner status, last-active signal

Primary Action: View only — no approval or action required

Product Wireframes Link: <https://app.visily.ai/projects/78b979ae-2b13-493b-bb6b-d35b471bedbb/boards/2634081/presenter?play-mode=All+screens>



SLIDE 7

Metrics & Launch Plan

North Star Metric

Course Completion Rate

% of enrolled learners who complete a course AND submit at least one learning application reflection

Metrics Framework

Input Metrics	Outcome Metrics	Business Metrics
Commitment Creation Rate	Course Completion Rate	L&D Satisfaction Score
Milestone Adherence Rate	Learner Engagement Rate	Enterprise Renewal Rate
Reflection Submission Rate	Learning Application Rate	Training ROI
Weekly Active Learners		

GTM & Rollout Strategy

Pilot Rollout

- Launch to 5% of learners
- Across 3–5 enterprise customers
- Focus on self-paced learning programs

Pilot Goals

- Validate commitment adoption
- Measure milestone engagement
- Assess learning application
- Quantify completion-rate uplift

Guided Learning Commitments transforms self-paced learning into a structured, accountable, and application-driven experience — improving completion and engagement.

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